

Game: Omori

<https://lrpost.org/wp-content/uploads/2021/12/maxresdefault.jpeg>

So in Omori the player is put in control of a monochromatic, soulless looking character named Omori. This character moves around in a vibrant, hyper-colorful, pastel dream world known as Headspace. This is the primary trigger for the Proteus Effect, as you cannot have more of an opposite dynamic between the real-world person and the on-screen character. The fact that Omori has no color, a blank expression, and a knife gives the player's playstyle, both intentionally and unintentionally, a more calculating and colder, if not brutal, persona. The avatar in this game is designed to give the player a signal that they are the unbreakable, unemotional glue for this team, which, by itself, can manipulate a player into a more brutal or cold playstyle.

Another effect being utilized is Transformed Social Interaction. In the narrative Omori acts as a psychological defense mechanism to real world protagonist, Sunny. By playing Omori the player's interactions with the relentlessly cheerful, colorful NPCs are entirely manipulated. This allows Omori's emotionless form to fool the player into a sense of security and emotional detachment, allowing the underlying issues of the game's narrative to be masked.

So do I think this really works? Yes. I believe a player isn't going to go around acting like an emotionless knife wielding dream being in real life, but the psychological bleeding effect during play does happen. If a player controls a character that is deliberately closed off from emotions and represses them all, than they, too, will naturally mimic that closed off and repressed state of mind. This is a clear example that an avatar's looks don't just alter your appearance in a game they manipulate your baseline emotionality and interaction with everything around you.